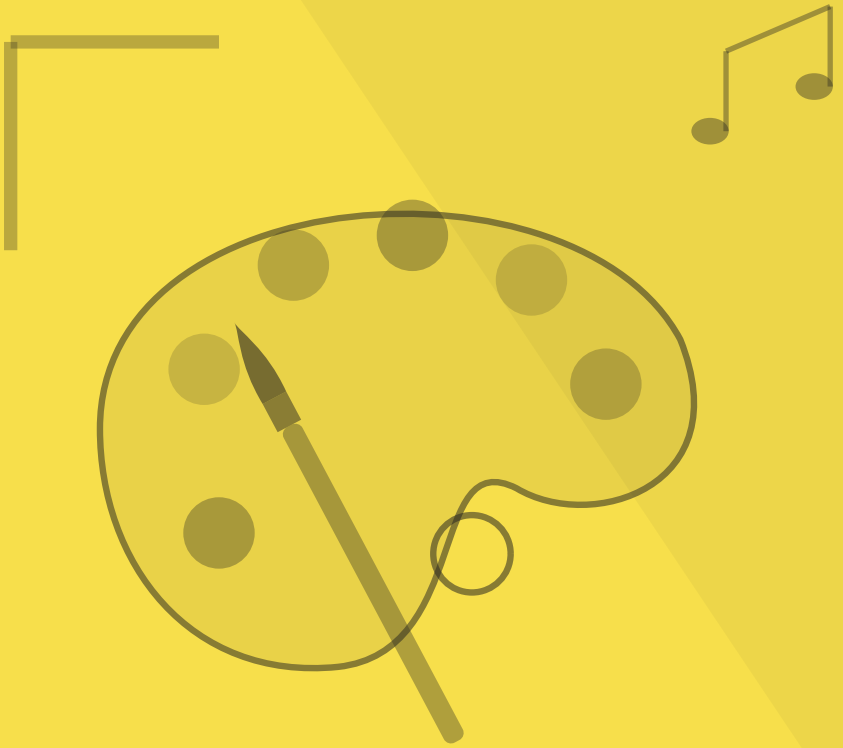
VENVLEARNING

TEACHER EDITION



Art

GRADE 4

Guided lessons, pacing, and complete answer keys

2026–2027 School Year · Unit 1: The Elements of Art

VENVLEARNING

Grade 4
Art

TEACHER EDITION

2026–2027 School Year

Unit 1 The Elements of Art

A VenvLearning family homeschool curriculum

How to use this Teacher Edition

This book holds everything needed to teach the course: unit overviews, a plan for every lesson with what to say and do, the student lesson with Try It answers, and answer keys for every workbook page, weekly check and unit test.

- Daily routine (about 45–55 minutes): Look and Talk 5 · Learn and Demonstrate 10 · Create 25 · Reflect 5.
- Say: lines are a suggested script. Use your own words.
- Monday and Wednesday are lessons. Friday is the Sketchbook Check (about 15 minutes), then corrections or a project.
- Dates match the VenvLearning lesson plans for the 2026–2027 school year.

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UNIT 1 · TEACHER OVERVIEW

The Elements of Art

Looking like an artist, line, shape and form, proportion, color, value and contrast, composition, and revision.

Every artwork, from a cave painting to a cartoon, is built from the same ingredients: line, shape, form, color, value, texture, and space. In this unit you'll learn to look like an artist, then practice each element in your own work, plan a composition, and use feedback to make a finished piece for your portfolio.

Big ideas

- Observe and describe art using the elements of art.
- Use line, shape, form, and proportion in drawings.
- Mix colors, make value scales, and use contrast.
- Plan compositions and revise with feedback.

Standards

Code	Standard
NCAS VA:Cr1–3	Generate, develop, and refine artwork.
NCAS VA:Re7–9	Perceive, interpret, and evaluate art.

What students should already know

- Using pencils, crayons, and paint.

Materials for the unit

- Sketchbook and drawing pencils
- Red, yellow, blue, black, and white paint; brushes; palettes
- Colored pencils and markers
- Mirror

- Portfolio folder

Pacing calendar

Week	Day	Lesson	Title
Week of Oct 12	Mon 10/12	1.1	Looking Like an Artist
Week of Oct 12	Wed 10/14	1.2	Line
Week of Oct 12	Fri 10/16	Check	Sketchbook Check 1: Looking and Line
Week of Oct 19	Mon 10/19	1.3	Shape and Form
Week of Oct 19	Wed 10/21	1.4	Proportion
Week of Oct 19	Fri 10/23	Check	Sketchbook Check 2: Shape, Form, and Proportion
Week of Oct 26	Mon 10/26	1.5	Color
Week of Oct 26	Wed 10/28	1.6	Value and Contrast
Week of Oct 26	Fri 10/30	Check	Sketchbook Check 3: Color and Value
Week of Nov 2	Mon 11/2	1.7	Composition
Week of Nov 2	Wed 11/4	1.8	Revision and Kind, Specific Feedback
Week of Nov 2	Fri 11/6	Test	Unit 1 Portfolio Review

TEACHING THIS UNIT AT HOME

Visit the Walter Anderson Museum of Art in Ocean Springs, or look at his work online, and play See, Think, Wonder together.

UNIT VOCABULARY

elements of art	Line, shape, form, color, value, texture, space.
proportion	Size relationships.
primary colors	Red, yellow, blue.
contrast	A big difference that stands out.
composition	How parts are arranged.
revise	Change and improve.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.1 · NCAS VA:Re7, VA:Re8 · Mon Oct 12

Lesson 1.1: Looking Like an Artist

I can look closely at artwork and describe what I see using the elements of art.

Objective	Students observe closely and describe art using the elements.
Standard	NCAS VA:Re7, VA:Re8 — Perceive and analyze artistic work; interpret intent and meaning.
Date	Mon Oct 12
Time	About 45 minutes
Materials	Sketchbook, pencils, natural objects, workbook Lesson 1.1
Get ready	Read the lesson, gather the studio materials, and try the Create activity yourself first so you can model it.

Lesson Flow

Part	Min	What to do and say
Look and Talk	5	One-minute silent looking.
Learn and Demonstrate	10	Introduce the seven elements. Model See, Think, Wonder with any artwork.
Create	25	Nature Observation Sketch.
Reflect	5	Students share one success and one thing to try next time; store work in the portfolio folder.

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

- Drawing from memory instead of observation.

SUPPORT

- Use a viewfinder (a paper frame) to focus on one part.

EXTEND

- Draw the same object from three angles.

STUDENT LESSON 1.1 · WITH ANSWERS

Lesson 1.1: Looking Like an Artist

LOOK AND WONDER

Look at any picture on your wall for one whole minute without talking. What did you notice in the last 30 seconds that you missed at first?

Artists are expert lookers. Before they make art, they spend a lot of time observing: noticing shapes, colors, and tiny details most people walk past. When we talk about art, we use the elements of art, the building blocks every artist uses.

Element	What it is
line	a mark that moves from one point to another
shape	a flat area with edges (2-D)
form	a shape with depth, like a ball or box (3-D)
color	what we see when light reflects off something: red, blue, yellow, and more
value	how light or dark something is
texture	how something feels, or looks like it would feel
space	the area around, between, and inside things

Walter Anderson (1903–1965) was an artist from Ocean Springs, Mississippi. He rowed a small boat out to Horn Island in the Gulf of Mexico and spent days drawing and painting the birds, crabs, plants, and waves he found there. He looked so closely that his watercolors seem to move. He's a great example of an artist who learned by observing.

STEP BY STEP · SEE, THINK, WONDER

Use these three steps to look at any artwork.

1 See: What do you see? Name only what is really there (colors, lines, objects).

2 Think: What do you think is going on? Why?

3 Wonder: What questions do you have?

Look for: Slow, careful looking first; ideas and questions second.

CREATE · NATURE OBSERVATION SKETCH

How much can you notice in 10 minutes?

You need: pencil; sketchbook or paper; a leaf, flower, shell, or pinecone.

1 Set your object in front of you.

2 Look for one full minute before you draw.

3 Draw it slowly, looking at the object more than at your paper.

4 Add three labels for details you noticed (veins, spots, edges).

Record: your sketch with three labeled details.

KEY IDEA

Artists look closely first. The elements of art (line, shape, form, color, value, texture, space) give us words for what we see.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Answers are shown in red.

1. Name three elements of art.

Answer: any three of line, shape, form, color, value, texture, space

2. Where did Walter Anderson go to draw nature?

Answer: Horn Island, in the Gulf of Mexico

3. What are the three steps of See, Think, Wonder?

Answer: see what's there, think about what's going on, wonder (ask questions)

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.1.

Workbook Answer Key · Lesson 1.1

#	Question	Answer
1	To look closely and carefully	observe
2	How light or dark something is	value
3	Choose an artwork (a book illustration, a museum website, or art in your home). Write one See, one Think, and one Wonder.	Answers vary.
4	Draw your nature object from observation. Label three details.	Look for careful observation and three labeled details.
5	Which element of art did you notice most in your object? Why?	Answers vary.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.2 · NCAS VA:Cr1, VA:Cr2 · Wed Oct 14

Lesson 1.2: Line

I can create different kinds of lines and use them to show movement and feeling.

Objective	Students create and use expressive lines.
Standard	NCAS VA:Cr1, VA:Cr2 — Generate and develop artistic ideas.
Date	Wed Oct 14
Time	About 45 minutes
Materials	Pencils, markers, paper, workbook Lesson 1.2
Get ready	Read the lesson, gather the studio materials, and try the Create activity yourself first so you can model it.

Lesson Flow

Part	Min	What to do and say
Look and Talk	5	Calm line vs excited line.
Learn and Demonstrate	10	Demonstrate eight kinds of line. Discuss line direction and feeling; show The Starry Night.
Create	25	Line Sampler and Line Feelings.
Reflect	5	Students share one success and one thing to try next time; store work in the portfolio folder.

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

- Pressing too hard so lines can't vary.

SUPPORT

- Show thick vs thin by changing pressure.

EXTEND

- Make a line drawing of music as it plays.

STUDENT LESSON 1.2 · WITH ANSWERS

Lesson 1.2: Line

LOOK AND WONDER

Draw a line that looks calm. Now draw a line that looks excited. What's different?

Line is the first element most artists use. Lines can be straight, curved, zigzag, wavy, spiral, dotted, thick, or thin. Lines also carry feelings: flat horizontal lines feel calm and restful, tall vertical lines feel strong, and slanted diagonal lines feel full of movement.



straight curved zigzag wavy spiral dotted thick thin

In The Starry Night (1889), Vincent van Gogh used thick, swirling, curving lines to make the night sky look like it is moving. Find a picture of it online or in a library book and trace the swirls with your finger.

CREATE · LINE SAMPLER AND LINE FEELINGS

How can lines show feelings?

You need: pencil; black marker; paper.

1. Fold a paper into eight boxes.
2. Fill each box with a different kind of line (straight, curved, zigzag, wavy, spiral, dotted, thick, thin).
3. On a new paper, draw a simple landscape using only lines that feel calm.
4. Draw the same landscape again using only lines that feel stormy.

Record: both landscapes and a sentence about which lines you chose.

KEY IDEA

Lines can be many kinds, and their direction and shape carry feeling: horizontal = calm, vertical = strong, diagonal = movement.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Answers are shown in red.

1. What feeling do horizontal lines often show?

Answer: calm, rest

2. What kind of line shows the outside edge of a shape?

Answer: contour line

3. What kind of lines did van Gogh use in the sky?

Answer: swirling, curving lines

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.2.

Workbook Answer Key · Lesson 1.2

#	Question	Answer
1	Lines that slant	diagonal
2	Lines that go straight up and down	vertical
3	Line sampler: fill each part of this space with a different kind of line. Label each one.	At least eight labeled line types.
4	Draw a tree using only zigzag and spiral lines.	Creative use of the two line types.
5	Which kind of line would you use to show a race car? Why?	Diagonal or zigzag lines, because they show speed and movement.

SKETCHBOOK CHECK · Fri Oct 16

Sketchbook Check 1: Looking and Line — Answer Key

Answers

#	Question	Answer
1	Name four elements of art.	any four of line, shape, form, color, value, texture, space
2	Feeling of horizontal lines	calm
3	Feeling of diagonal lines	movement
4	Draw three different kinds of lines and label them.	Three correctly labeled line types.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.3 · NCAS VA:Cr2 · Mon Oct 19

Lesson 1.3: Shape and Form

I can tell shapes from forms, sort shapes as geometric or organic, and use shading to make a shape look 3-D.

Objective	Students distinguish shape and form and shade forms.
Standard	NCAS VA:Cr2 — Organize and develop artistic ideas and work.
Date	Mon Oct 19
Time	About 45 minutes
Materials	Pencils, paper, ball, lamp, workbook Lesson 1.3
Get ready	Read the lesson, gather the studio materials, and try the Create activity yourself first so you can model it.

Lesson Flow

Part	Min	What to do and say
Look and Talk	5	Circle vs ball.
Learn and Demonstrate	10	Demonstrate shading a sphere. Show Matisse cut-outs.
Create	25	From Shape to Form.
Reflect	5	Students share one success and one thing to try next time; store work in the portfolio folder.

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

- Shading all around the edge evenly (looks flat).

SUPPORT	EXTEND
• Mark the light source with an arrow first.	• Make a Matisse-style cut-paper collage.

STUDENT LESSON 1.3 · WITH ANSWERS

Lesson 1.3: Shape and Form

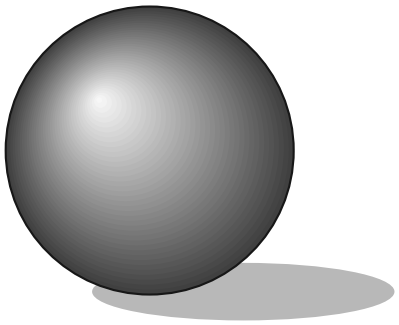
LOOK AND WONDER

Is a circle the same as a ball? How could you draw a circle so it looks like a ball?

Shapes are flat (two-dimensional). Geometric shapes have exact edges; organic shapes are free and irregular, like things in nature. Forms are three-dimensional: a circle becomes a sphere, a square becomes a cube, a triangle becomes a cone or pyramid.

Shape (2-D)	Form (3-D)
circle	sphere (ball)
square	cube (box)
rectangle	cylinder or rectangular prism
triangle	cone or pyramid

In his last years, Henri Matisse "drew with scissors," cutting bold organic shapes from painted paper, as in The Snail (1953). Artists can also turn a flat shape into a form by shading: darker values on the side away from the light.



Shading turns a flat circle into a round form.

CREATE · FROM SHAPE TO FORM

How can shading make a shape look three-dimensional?

You need: pencil; paper; a ball or orange and a lamp or window light.

1. Draw a circle. Decide where the light is coming from.
2. Shade the side away from the light darker, blending smoothly.
3. Leave a small bright spot (highlight) near the light side.
4. Add a shadow on the ground under the ball.

Record: your shaded sphere and a flat circle side by side.

KEY IDEA

Shapes are flat; forms have depth. Shading on the side away from the light turns a shape into a form.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Answers are shown in red.

1. Geometric or organic: a leaf

Answer: organic

2. What form does a circle become?

Answer: a sphere

3. Where does shading go?

Answer: on the side away from the light

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.3.

Workbook Answer Key · Lesson 1.3

#	Question	Answer
1	Flat, with edges	shape
2	Has height, width, and depth	form
3	puddle	organic
4	stop sign	geometric
5	cloud	organic
6	window	geometric
7	Draw and shade a sphere, a cube, and a cylinder. Show where the light comes from.	Shading consistent with one light source.
8	Why did Matisse's cut-outs use mostly organic shapes, do you think?	Answers vary; e.g., they feel lively and natural, like plants and sea creatures.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.4 · NCAS VA:Cr2, VA:Cr3 · Wed Oct 21

Lesson 1.4: Proportion

I can use proportion to draw a face with parts in the right size and place.

Objective	Students use proportion guidelines to draw a face.
Standard	NCAS VA:Cr2, VA:Cr3 — Develop and refine artistic work.
Date	Wed Oct 21
Time	About 45 minutes
Materials	Pencils, erasers, mirrors, workbook Lesson 1.4
Get ready	Read the lesson, gather the studio materials, and try the Create activity yourself first so you can model it.

Lesson Flow

Part	Min	What to do and say
Look and Talk	5	Where are your eyes?
Learn and Demonstrate	10	Demonstrate the face guide step by step.
Create	25	Proportional Self-Portrait.
Reflect	5	Students share one success and one thing to try next time; store work in the portfolio folder.

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

- Drawing eyes high on the head; drawing guidelines too dark.

SUPPORT

- Pre-drawn ovals with guidelines.

EXTEND

- Draw a family member using the same guide.

STUDENT LESSON 1.4 · WITH ANSWERS

Lesson 1.4: Proportion

LOOK AND WONDER

Where are your eyes on your head: near the top, or halfway down? Make a guess, then check in a mirror with a ruler.

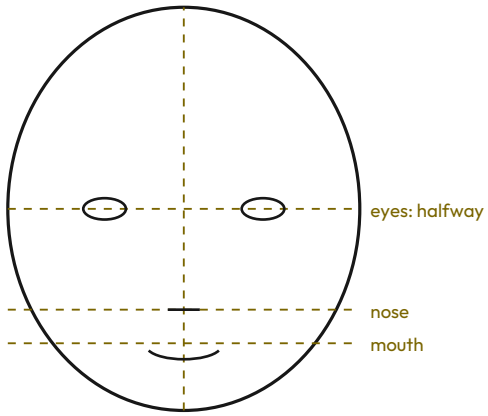
Proportion means the size relationships between parts. Most people draw eyes too high! On most faces, the eyes are about halfway between the top of the head and the chin. Artists use guidelines to place features.

Face guide: draw an oval. A line halfway down shows where the eyes go.

The bottom of the nose is about halfway between the eyes and the chin.

The mouth is about one-third of the way from the nose to the chin.

Eyes are about one eye-width apart.



Artists sometimes break proportion on purpose. Cartoonists draw big heads and huge eyes to look cute or funny. That's called exaggeration.

CREATE · PROPORTIONAL SELF-PORTRAIT

Can guidelines help you draw a face that looks right?

You need: pencil; eraser; mirror; paper.

1. Draw a large oval. Lightly draw the halfway line and a center line.
2. Place the eyes on the halfway line, one eye-width apart.
3. Add the nose and mouth using the guide.
4. Look in the mirror to add hair, ears (between the eye line and nose line), and details.
5. Erase the guidelines.

Record: your self-portrait.

KEY IDEA

Proportion is size relationships. Eyes sit about halfway down the head.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Answers are shown in red.

1. Where are the eyes on most faces?

Answer: about halfway down the head

2. Where do the ears usually line up?

Answer: between the eye line and the bottom of the nose

3. What is exaggeration?

Answer: changing proportion on purpose for effect

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.4.

Workbook Answer Key · Lesson 1.4

#	Question	Answer
1	A picture of a person	portrait
2	Size relationships between parts	proportion
3	Draw a face using the face guide steps.	Eyes at halfway line; nose and mouth placed with guides.
4	What surprised you about where facial features go?	Answers vary; most notice eyes are lower than expected.

SKETCHBOOK CHECK · Fri Oct 23

Sketchbook Check 2: Shape, Form, and Proportion — Answer Key

Answers

#	Question	Answer
1	Geometric or organic: a flower	organic
2	A circle as a form is a…	sphere
3	Where are the eyes on most faces?	about halfway down the head
4	Draw and shade a sphere with a light source.	Shading opposite the light; highlight; cast shadow.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.5 · NCAS VA:Cr2 · Mon Oct 26

Lesson 1.5: Color

I can name primary, secondary, and tertiary colors and mix secondary colors.

Objective	Students identify and mix colors.
Standard	NCAS VA:Cr2 — Organize and develop artistic ideas and work.
Date	Mon Oct 26
Time	About 45 minutes
Materials	Red/yellow/blue paint, brushes, water, palettes, workbook Lesson 1.5
Get ready	Read the lesson, gather the studio materials, and try the Create activity yourself first so you can model it.

Lesson Flow

Part	Min	What to do and say
Look and Talk	5	How many colors from three?
Learn and Demonstrate	10	Demonstrate mixing green and orange.
Create	25	Paint a Color Wheel.
Reflect	5	Students share one success and one thing to try next time; store work in the portfolio folder.

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

- Muddy colors from dirty brushes.

SUPPORT

- Pre-labeled wheel template.

EXTEND

- Mix three different greens and compare them.

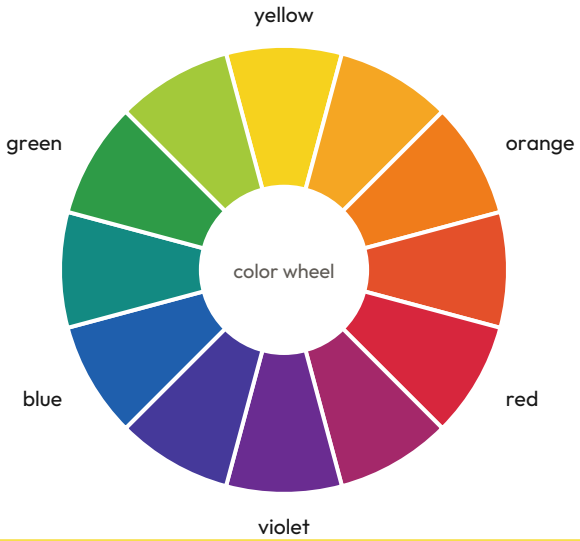
STUDENT LESSON 1.5 · WITH ANSWERS

Lesson 1.5: Color

LOOK AND WONDER

If you only had red, yellow, and blue paint, how many colors could you make?

The painter's color wheel starts with three primary colors: red, yellow, and blue. Mix two primaries to get a secondary color: red + yellow = orange, yellow + blue = green, blue + red = violet. Mix a primary with a neighboring secondary to get a tertiary color, such as yellow-green or red-violet.



STEP BY STEP · MIX A SECONDARY COLOR

Make green.

1 Put a small puddle of yellow on your palette.

2 Add a tiny bit of blue and mix. (Blue is strong; add it a little at a time.)

3 Keep adding blue until you like the green.

Look for: Start with the lighter color and add the darker color slowly.

CREATE · PAINT A COLOR WHEEL

Can you make every color on the wheel from three primaries?

You need: red, yellow, and blue paint; brush; water cup; paper towel; paper plate palette; the workbook color wheel template.

1 Paint the three primary colors in their spaces.

2 Mix and paint the three secondary colors.

3 Mix and paint the six tertiary colors.

4 Clean your brush between colors.

Record: your finished 12-part color wheel.

KEY IDEA

Primary colors mix to make secondary colors; primary + neighboring secondary makes tertiary colors.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Answers are shown in red.

1. Red + yellow = ?

Answer: orange

2. Name the three primary colors.

Answer: red, yellow, blue

3. Name a tertiary color.

Answer: e.g. yellow-green, blue-violet, red-orange

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.5.

Workbook Answer Key · Lesson 1.5

#	Question	Answer
1	Yellow + blue =	green
2	Blue + red =	violet (purple)
3	Primary or secondary: orange	secondary
4	Primary or secondary: blue	primary
5	Yellow + green =	yellow-green (tertiary)
6	Which primary is not in green?	red
7	Color wheel template: paint or color all 12 parts in order.	Correct order: yellow, yellow-orange, orange, red-orange, red, red-violet, violet, blue-violet, blue, blue-green, green, yellow-green.
8	Why should you add dark colors to light colors a little at a time?	Dark colors are strong and can quickly overpower a light color.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.6 · NCAS VA:Cr2, VA:Re7 · Wed Oct 28

Lesson 1.6: Value and Contrast

I can make tints and shades, create a value scale, and use contrast to make something stand out.

Objective	Students create value scales and use contrast.
Standard	NCAS VA:Cr2, VA:Re7 — Organize and develop artistic work; perceive artistic choices.
Date	Wed Oct 28
Time	About 45 minutes
Materials	Paint or colored pencils, workbook Lesson 1.6
Get ready	Read the lesson, gather the studio materials, and try the Create activity yourself first so you can model it.

Lesson Flow

Part	Min	What to do and say
Look and Talk	5	Stop signs and buses.
Learn and Demonstrate	10	Demonstrate tints and shades. Show complements on the color wheel.
Create	25	High-Contrast Picture.
Reflect	5	Students share one success and one thing to try next time; store work in the portfolio folder.

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

- Big jumps between values instead of even steps.

SUPPORT

- Use only pencil pressure for value.

EXTEND

- Paint a monochromatic (one-color) picture using only tints and shades.

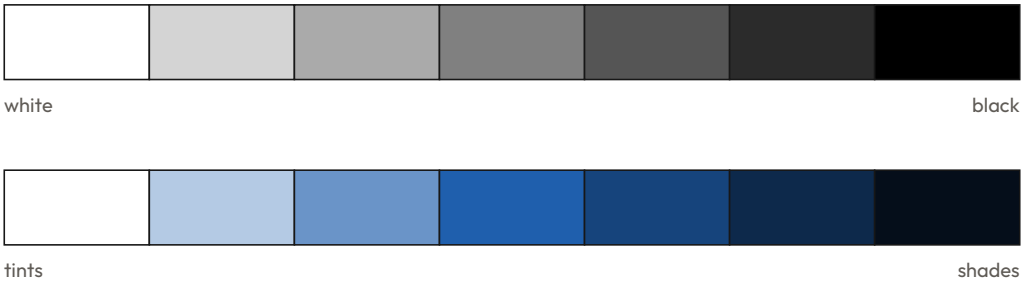
STUDENT LESSON 1.6 · WITH ANSWERS

Lesson 1.6: Value and Contrast

LOOK AND WONDER

Why are stop signs red and white, and school buses yellow and black?

Value is lightness or darkness. Add white to make a tint; add black to make a shade. A value scale shows the steps from light to dark.



Tints and shades of blue.

Contrast is a big difference, and it grabs attention. Light next to dark is high contrast. Complementary colors, which sit opposite each other on the color wheel (red and green, blue and orange, yellow and violet), also make strong contrast.

CREATE · HIGH-CONTRAST PICTURE

How can contrast make one thing stand out?

You need: paint or colored pencils; black and white paint or pencils; paper.

1. Make a 5-step value scale of one color, from tint to shade.
2. Draw a simple subject (a fish, a flower, a rocket).
3. Color the subject with one color and the background with its complement.
4. Check: does your subject pop out?

Record: your value scale and your high-contrast picture.

KEY IDEA

Tints are lighter, shades are darker; contrast (light vs dark, or complements) makes things stand out.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Answers are shown in red.

1. What do you add to make a tint?

Answer: white

2. What is the complement of blue?

Answer: orange

3. Why are school buses yellow and black?

Answer: high contrast is easy to see

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.6.

Workbook Answer Key · Lesson 1.6

#	Question	Answer
1	Lightness or darkness	value
2	Color + black =	shade
3	Complement of red	green
4	Complement of yellow	violet
5	Pink is a ___ of red.	tint
6	Navy is a ___ of blue.	shade
7	Make a 5-step value scale with your pencil, from lightest to darkest.	Five clearly different, evenly stepped values.
8	Sketch a subject that stands out using contrast.	Clear contrast between subject and background.
9	Name a place you see contrast used to get attention (a sign, a logo, a jersey).	Answers vary.

SKETCHBOOK CHECK · Fri Oct 30

Sketchbook Check 3: Color and Value — Answer Key

Answers

#	Question	Answer
1	Blue + yellow =	green
2	Complement of orange	blue
3	Color + white =	tint
4	Name a tertiary color.	e.g. red-violet
5	Make a 5-step value scale.	Even steps from light to dark.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.7 · NCAS VA:Cr1, VA:Cr2 · Mon Nov 2

Lesson 1.7: Composition

I can plan a composition with a clear focal point and balance.

Objective	Students plan compositions using thumbnails.
Standard	NCAS VA:Cr1, VA:Cr2 — Generate and conceptualize artistic ideas.
Date	Mon Nov 2
Time	About 45 minutes
Materials	Pencils, paper, workbook Lesson 1.7
Get ready	Read the lesson, gather the studio materials, and try the Create activity yourself first so you can model it.

Lesson Flow

Part	Min	What to do and say
Look and Talk	5	Photos and the middle.
Learn and Demonstrate	10	Show rule of thirds; discuss The Great Wave.
Create	25	Thumbnail Planning.
Reflect	5	Students share one success and one thing to try next time; store work in the portfolio folder.

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

- Making thumbnails too detailed.

SUPPORT

- Pre-drawn thumbnail boxes.

EXTEND

- Take four photos of one object using different compositions.

STUDENT LESSON 1.7 · WITH ANSWERS

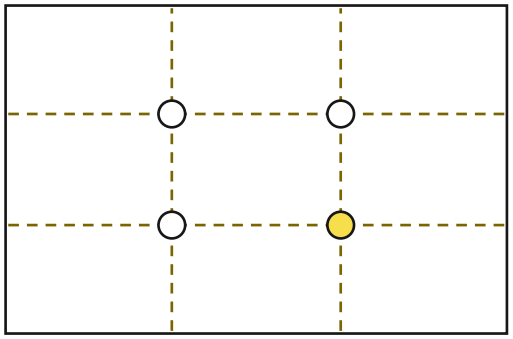
Lesson 1.7: Composition

LOOK AND WONDER

When you take a photo, do you always put the main thing right in the middle? What happens if you don't?

Composition is how an artist arranges everything in the picture. A strong composition has a focal point, the spot your eye goes to first, and balance. Symmetrical balance is the same on both sides; asymmetrical balance uses different things that feel equally weighted.

Many artists place the focal point a little off center. Divide the picture into thirds both ways; the four places where the lines cross are strong spots for a focal point.



In The Great Wave off Kanagawa (about 1831), the Japanese artist Katsushika Hokusai placed a huge curling wave on the left and a tiny Mount Fuji low in the middle, framed by the wave.

CREATE · THUMBNAIL PLANNING

Which arrangement makes the strongest picture?

You need: pencil; paper.

1. Choose a subject: your pet, your house, or a favorite place.
2. Draw four small boxes (thumbnails).
3. Sketch the subject a different way in each: centered, off center, close up, far away.
4. Circle the strongest one and explain why.

Record: four thumbnails with your choice circled.

KEY IDEA

Plan the arrangement: choose a focal point (often off center), balance the picture, and try ideas small first.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Answers are shown in red.

1. What is a focal point?

Answer: the part your eye goes to first

2. What kind of balance is the same on both sides?

Answer: symmetrical

3. What is a thumbnail sketch?

Answer: a small, quick planning drawing

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.7.

Workbook Answer Key · Lesson 1.7

#	Question	Answer
1	How parts are arranged	composition
2	Balance that is different on each side but still feels even	asymmetrical
3	Draw four thumbnail sketches of one subject. Circle your best composition.	Four varied thumbnails; one circled with a reason.
4	Why do artists make thumbnails before a final piece?	To try ideas quickly and choose the strongest one before spending time on a final.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.8 · NCAS VA:Cr3, VA:Re9 · Wed Nov 4

Lesson 1.8: Revision and Kind, Specific Feedback

I can give and use kind, specific, helpful feedback to improve my artwork.

Objective	Students give feedback and revise artwork.
Standard	NCAS VA:Cr3, VA:Re9 — Refine and complete artistic work; apply criteria to evaluate work.
Date	Wed Nov 4
Time	About 45 minutes
Materials	Thumbnails, paper, color media, workbook Lesson 1.8, Unit 1 Review
Get ready	Read the lesson, gather the studio materials, and try the Create activity yourself first so you can model it.

Lesson Flow

Part	Min	What to do and say
Look and Talk	5	Helpful vs unhelpful comments.
Learn and Demonstrate	10	Show Austin's Butterfly if available. Model kind, specific, helpful feedback.
Create	25	Draft, Feedback, Final.
Reflect	5	Students compare draft and final; store both in the portfolio. Friday: Unit 1 Portfolio Review.

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

- Feedback that is only praise.

SUPPORT

- Feedback sentence starters.

EXTEND

- Give feedback on a sibling's work.

STUDENT LESSON 1.8 · WITH ANSWERS

Lesson 1.8: Revision and Kind, Specific Feedback

LOOK AND WONDER

What's more helpful: “It's good!” or “The eyes look great; maybe make the background darker so your face stands out”?

Artists rarely get it right the first time. They make drafts, get feedback, and revise. Good feedback is kind (respectful), specific (names exactly what to look at), and helpful (gives an idea to try).

In a well-known video called Austin's Butterfly, a first grader named Austin draws a butterfly six times. After each draft, classmates give kind, specific feedback, and his final drawing is amazingly detailed. Watch it with your teacher if you can.

Instead of…	Try…
“I like it.”	“I like how your wavy lines make the water look like it's moving.”
“It's bad.”	“The house is small; could you make it bigger so it's the focal point?”
“Fix the colors.”	“Try a complementary color behind the bird so it stands out.”

CREATE · DRAFT, FEEDBACK, FINAL

How much can feedback improve a drawing?

You need: your best thumbnail from Lesson 1.7; paper; colored pencils or paint.

1. Make a larger draft from your thumbnail.
2. Ask your teacher or a family member for one kind, specific, helpful comment.
3. Revise based on the feedback.
4. Add color, using value and contrast.
5. Put your draft and final side by side.

Record: your draft, the feedback, and your final piece for your portfolio.

KEY IDEA

Kind, specific, helpful feedback plus revision makes art (and everything else) better.

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Answers are shown in red.

1. Name the three parts of good feedback.

Answer: kind, specific, helpful

2. What did Austin do to improve his butterfly?

Answer: made several drafts and used classmates' feedback

3. What does revise mean?

Answer: to change and improve your work

More practice: Workbook, Lesson 1.8.

Workbook Answer Key · Lesson 1.8

#	Question	Answer
1	To change and improve	revise
2	A thoughtful discussion of art	critique
3	Rewrite “It's nice” as kind, specific, helpful feedback for a picture of a dog.	e.g. I like the fluffy texture of the fur; maybe add a shadow under the dog so it looks like it's standing on the ground.
4	Final piece: draw your revised composition here (or attach your painting).	Shows revision from draft; uses line, shape, color, value, and composition.
5	What feedback did you use, and how did it change your art?	Answers vary.

UNIT REVIEW · Thu Nov 5 (homework) or as needed

Unit 1 Review — Answer Key

Use as a study session or portfolio sort before the review.

Answers

#	Question	Answer
1	line	a mark from one point to another
2	form	3-D object
3	proportion	size relationships
4	value	lightness or darkness
5	contrast	a big difference, such as light vs dark
6	focal point	where the eye goes first
7	Gather your best work from Unit 1. Which piece shows the most growth? Why?	Answers vary.

PORTFOLIO REVIEW · Fri Nov 6

Unit 1 Portfolio Review — Answer Key

Answers

#	Question	Answer
1	Which is a form? A. circle B. sphere C. square	B. sphere
2	Red, yellow, and blue are… A. secondary colors B. primary colors C. tertiary colors	B. primary colors
3	What does adding black make?	a shade
4	Which line direction shows calm?	horizontal
5	Name the complement of violet.	yellow
6	Where should a focal point often go?	a little off center (on a rule-of-thirds spot)
7	Choose one artwork from this unit (The Starry Night, The Snail, The Great Wave, or a Walter Anderson painting). Describe how the artist used two elements of art.	Rubric: names two elements (1); accurate details from the artwork (1); explains the effect (1).
8	Choose your final piece from Lesson 1.8. Your teacher will score it with this rubric. Then write two sentences about your choices.	Rubric (1 point each): clear focal point; varied line; shapes and forms; color mixing; value or contrast; evidence of revision from draft.

Scoring

Score	What it means / next step
13–15 (85%+)	Excellent: strong skills and thoughtful choices.
11–12	Solid: revisit one technique.
Below 11	Redo one studio activity with support.

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